

1)

Please select a passage from any of the texts we have read up until this point in the semester (3-5-26). Please quote the passage in its entirety. Please explicate the passage, that is, please explain in your own words what the passage means, how it relates to the rest of the text, and what the passage contributes to the overarching structure of the text.

The text passage I am choosing to write on is in Spinoza's "Treatise on the Emendation of the Intellect" and is paragraph 19 which is on page 237:

"If I examine them carefully, they can all be classified under four headings.

1. There is the perception we have from hearsay, or from some sign conventionally agreed upon.
2. There is the perception we have from casual experience; that is, experience that is not determined by intellect, but is so called because it chances thus to occur, and we have experienced nothing else that contradicts it, so that it remains in our minds unchallenged.
3. There is the perception we have when the essence of a thing is inferred from another thing, but not adequately. This happens either when we infer a cause from some effect or when an inference is made from some universal which is made from some universal which is always accompanied by some property
4. Finally, there is the perception we have when a thing is perceived through its essence alone, or through knowledge of its proximate cause."¹

2)

Please give a philosophical assessment of the significance or interest of the passage.

¹Spinoza, Benedictus de, Samuel Shirley, and Seymour Feldman. *The Ethics ; Treatise on the Emendation of the Intellect ; Selected Letters*. 2nd ed. Indianapolis: Hackett Pub. Co., 1992.